WINTER 2026/27 · COLD WEATHER PAYMENT

£25 for each 7 days running at zero or below.

If you get one of a short list of benefits, meet that benefit's own conditions, and the average temperature where you live sits at zero or below for seven days running, money goes into your account. Nothing to claim — but a new child in the house has to be reported.

WHICH BENEFITS IT RUNS ON

4

Pension Credit, Universal Credit, income-related Employment and Support Allowance, or Support for Mortgage Interest — each with its own conditions.

> Paid within **14 working days**, for cold spells from 1 Nov 2026 to 31 Mar 2027, by postcode. Not in Scotland — a qualifying benefit brings Winter Heating Payment there, once a winter.

WHO DOES NOT GET IT

2 tests

On Universal Credit both must hold:

neither the claimant nor their partner is employed or "gainfully self-employed" — self-employment as their main job, worked regularly and expecting a profit — AND one of them has limited capability for work or a child under 5 at home.

> A disabled child amount in the claim and it is paid either way. A new baby, or a child under 5 moving in, must be reported or it is not automatic.

WINTER 2026/27 · COLD WEATHER PAYMENT

Not sure where to check?

Message us and we will send you the official GOV.UK page where you can check it. No obligation.

0330 133 1886

General information, not benefits advice. Get specialist advice.